1. Article 74 There shall be a council of ministers with the Prime Minister at the head to aid and advise the President who shall, in the exercise of his/her functions, act in accordance with such advice. However, the President may require the council of ministers to reconsider such advice and the President shall act in accordance with the advice tendered after such reconsideration.

2. Article 75 (a) The Prime Minister shall be appointed by the President and the other ministers shall be appointed by the President on the advice of the Prime Minister; (b) The ministers shall hold office during the pleasure of the President; and (c) The council of ministers shall be collectively responsible to the House of the People.

3. Article 78 It shall be the duty of the Prime Minister:

(a) to communicate to the President all decisions of the council of ministers relating to the administration of the affairs of the Union and proposals for legislation;

(b) to furnish such information relating to the administration of the affairs of the Union and proposals for legislation as the President may call for; and

(c) if the President so requires, to submit for the consideration of the council of ministers any matter on which a decision has been taken by a minister but which has not been considered by the council.

CHIEF MINISTERS WHO BECAME PRIME MINISTERS

Six people—Morarji Desai, Charan Singh, V.P. Singh, P.V. Narasimha Rao, H.D. Deve Gowda and Narendra Modi—became Prime Ministers after being Chief Ministers of their respective States. Morarji Desai, Chief Minister of the erstwhile Bombay State during 1952–56, became the first non-Congress Prime Minister in March 1977. Charan Singh, who succeeded him, was the Chief Minister of the undivided Uttar Pradesh in 1967–1968 and again in 1970. V.P. Singh, also from U.P., became Prime Minister in the short lived National Front government (December 1989–November 1990). P.V. Narasimha Rao, the first Prime Minister from South India, who held the post from 1991–1996, was Chief Minister of Andhra Pradesh between 1971–1973. H.D. Deve Gowda was Chief Minister of Karnataka when he was chosen to lead the United Front government in June 1996[5].

Narendra Modi (BJP) was the Chief Minister of Gujarat when he became the Prime Minister in May 2014. He served as the Chief Minister of Gujarat for four times during 2001 to 2014.

CARETAKER GOVERNMENT

The Constitution of India does not contain any provision for a caretaker government. It is only a situational arrangement and a functional necessity.

 **Meaning**

The following points clearly doing out the meaning of a caretaker government:

1. The creation of a caretaker government after the dissolution of the popular chamber of the Parliament and its termination with the induction of a new ministry after the general election is an essential feature of the parliamentary system of government in operation. Such a government is enjoined upon to hold free and fair polls so that a new popular government comes into being[6].